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送信者: POLITICO Pro Alert 受信日時: 2026-09-16 16:36

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By Carlo Martuscelli · Sep 16, 2026, 9:35 AM · [View in your browser](#)

The EU wants to tackle its dependency on Chinese critical minerals and other raw materials by setting up a corporation tasked with coordinating purchases and building stockpiles, Commission President Ursula von der Leyen said in her State of the Union speech on Wednesday.

The bloc currently relies on Chinese mining and processing to deliver up to 90 percent of its supply needs for certain key metals used in high-tech sectors like batteries and semiconductors.

“We still have too many dangerous dependencies,” von der Leyen told European lawmakers in Strasbourg.

Beijing has, in the past, throttled exports of the materials during international disputes.

Japan, which was one of the first countries that was hit by Chinese exports on rare earths, set up a body called the Japan Organization for Metals and Energy Security (JOGMEC), backed by around €10.5 billion, to coordinate the purchasing and stockpiling of critical minerals.

Von der Leyen said the EU body, to be called the “European Corporation on Critical Raw Materials,” will have a similar function.

“It will help us obtain and stockpile what we need. For electric cars, chips and batteries, clean tech and defence. And so much more,” she said.

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